

FirstKnock Founder Cold Call Playbook

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Production-Ready Scripts, Objection Handling & Daily Execution Framework

2025

This playbook is written for one person: the founder of FirstKnock. Not a sales rep. Not a hired SDR. The person who built the product, knows every line of the data model, and is picking up the phone personally to find the operators who have the exact problem this software solves. Every script, every stat, every objection handle in this document is specific to pest control owners and home security dealers. Nothing is generic. Nothing is filler. Read it once. Then dial.

1–5% The problem you solve Blind D2D Conversion Rate	35–50% Wasted rep time Doors That Are Rentals	\$75K–\$145K The real ROI argument Cost to Replace One Rep	8x Your core promise Closes per 40 FK Doors vs. 100 Cold Doors
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SECTION 1: THE FOUNDER FRAME

Who You Are on This Call

You are not a sales rep reading from a script someone else wrote. You are the person who built FirstKnock because you watched D2D reps burn out in real time — knocking rental after rental, pitching people who legally cannot buy, losing their best doors to competitors who got there first. You saw the problem before you built the solution. That is your edge on every single call.

No one on the planet knows this product better than you. No one understands the data architecture, the verification layer, the rental filter, or the new homeowner targeting logic better than you. That is not a liability — that is the most powerful sales asset you have. When a prospect asks a hard question, you don't have to say 'let me check with the team.' You ARE the team. Own that.

You're Not Convincing Anyone — You're Qualifying

The single biggest mindset shift you need to make before you dial: you are not calling to convince anyone they have a problem. You are calling to find the people who already have the problem and don't yet know you solved it. The pest control owner who is losing reps to burnout every summer already knows something is broken. The security dealer whose Android users are complaining about the app crashing at the door already knows the pain. Your job is to show up, name the pain precisely, and show them the exit.

If they don't have the problem — or if the timing is wrong — move on. Fast. There are over 32,720

active pest control companies in the US alone. You are not running out of prospects. Qualification speed is a competitive advantage. The faster you disqualify the wrong ones, the faster you find the right ones.

Conviction Is the Product

Prospects can hear hesitation in the first five seconds. They can hear the difference between someone who believes in what they're selling and someone who is hoping the script holds up. You built this. You know it works. You know that shifting a rep from 100 cold doors to 40 verified homeowner doors produces 8x the closes with the same pitch and the same work ethic. That is not a marketing claim — that is the math. Speak from that place. Conviction is not aggression. It is calm certainty. The tone you want is: 'I already know this is going to help you. I'm just here to show you why.'

Peer-to-Peer, Operator-to-Operator

You are not calling up to these people. You are not a vendor pitching a buyer. You are one operator talking to another operator about a problem you both understand. When you call a pest control owner, you are talking to someone who manages field crews, deals with rep churn every summer, and has probably lost a great rep to burnout in the last 12 months. You understand their world. Speak like it. No corporate language. No 'I'd love to connect and share some insights.' Just: 'Here's what I'm seeing across the industry, here's what I built, here's what it does for teams like yours.'

Rejection Is Data, Not Defeat

When someone says 'not interested,' they are not rejecting you. They are telling you the timing is wrong, the framing didn't land, or they genuinely don't have the problem right now. All of that is useful information. Every 'no' is a data point that sharpens the next call. The goal of every call is: qualify fast, pitch sharp, close hard, move on. Not every call ends in a demo. That is fine. The math works in your favor if you stay disciplined and keep dialing.

THE GOAL OF EVERY CALL: Qualify fast. Pitch sharp. Close hard. Move on. You are not trying to win every call — you are trying to find the right calls.

Before You Dial — The 3-Point Reset

Before every dialing session — not just the first call, but every session — run through these three reminders out loud or in your head:

1. I built this because the problem is real. I am not guessing. I am not hoping. I know what 35-50% rental door waste does to a rep's morale, and I know what happens when you replace those doors with verified new homeowners. I have seen it. I built the solution.
2. I am calling to find people who already have this problem — not to create urgency where none exists. My job is to qualify fast and pitch the ones who are ready. The rest get a

follow-up sequence.

3. The number I do not book a demo with today is one step closer to the number I do. 80% of sales require 5 or more follow-up calls. I am playing a long game with short daily actions.

SECTION 2: THE DECISION MAKER QUALIFIER

Every version below is written for a specific entry scenario. Use the version that matches your situation. Do not improvise the opener — the first 8 seconds determine whether you get 30 more. All exact script words appear in bold. Tone notes follow each version.

Version A — You Have the Owner's Name

OPENER (Bad Time Check):

"Hey [First Name] — this is [YourName] over at FirstKnock. Did I catch you at a bad time?"

[Tone Note: Calm, unhurried, peer-level. Not apologetic. Not rushed. The 'bad time' opener is a pattern interrupt — most cold callers launch straight into a pitch. This pause signals confidence and respect for their time. It also gets a micro-yes that opens the conversation.]

YES BRANCH — They say 'No, go ahead' or 'What's this about?':

"Perfect. I'll be quick. I built a territory intelligence platform specifically for D2D pest control teams — it filters out all the rental doors in a territory and shows your reps only the verified homeowners who bought in the last 30 to 90 days. I'm calling because I wanted to show you what your specific territory looks like on the map. Takes 15 minutes. Is that something worth a quick look?"

[Tone Note: Confident, direct, no filler. 'I built' signals founder authority. 'Your specific territory' triggers territorial curiosity. End on a low-friction question — not 'can I schedule a demo' but 'is that worth a quick look.']

NO BRANCH — They say 'Actually, yeah, I'm in the middle of something':

"No problem at all — I respect that. When's a better time to catch you? I only need about 15 minutes and I'll pull up your territory live on the call so you can actually see the data."

IF THEY GIVE A TIME:

"Perfect — I'll call you [day] at [time]. I'll send a quick calendar hold to [email] so it doesn't get lost. What's the best email for you?"

[Tone Note: Get the email on this call. A calendar hold converts a vague 'call me Thursday' into a real commitment. Do not skip this step.]

Version B — You Have the Company Name, Not the Owner's Name

"Hey — I'm trying to reach the owner of [Company Name]. Is that something you can help me with?"

[Tone Note: Simple, direct, no over-explanation. 'Is that something you can help me with?' is a soft

ask that most people instinctively want to answer yes to.]

IF THEY ASK WHY:

"Sure — I built a territory intelligence tool for D2D pest control teams. I wanted to run something by the owner specifically because it's about how your reps are working their territories. Who would that be?"

[Tone Note: 'I built' again. Specificity ('how your reps are working their territories') signals you're not a generic vendor. You're calling about something operational and relevant. This usually gets you the name.]

ONCE YOU HAVE THE NAME:

"Great — is [Name] available now, or is there a better time to reach them directly?"

Version C — Receptionist / Gatekeeper

STEP 1 — Get the Owner's Name Naturally:

"Hey — who's the owner over there? I want to make sure I'm talking to the right person."

[Tone Note: Casual, not formal. 'Who's the owner over there' sounds like a peer asking, not a vendor requesting. Most receptionists answer this without thinking.]

STEP 2 — Request the Transfer:

"Perfect — is [Name] available right now?"

STEP 3 — If They Ask 'What's This About?' (Use the Hiring Signal Angle):

"Sure — I noticed [Company Name] is hiring sales reps right now. I built something specifically for growing D2D teams and I wanted to run it by [Owner's Name] for 30 seconds. It's about how to get more out of the reps you're bringing on."

[Tone Note: The hiring signal angle works because it's true — if they're hiring, they're growing, and growth creates the exact pain points FirstKnock solves. It also signals you did your homework, which builds instant credibility with the gatekeeper.]

STEP 4 — If the Owner Is Unavailable:

"No problem — when's the best time to catch them directly? I want to make sure I'm not interrupting them in the field."

STEP 5 — If They Ask You to Call Back:

"Absolutely — what time works best? And is there a direct line for [Name] so I'm not going through the main number again?"

[Tone Note: Always try to get the direct line. A direct line increases your connect rate from 3-5% (switchboard) to 8-15%. That is not a small difference — it is the difference between 1 connect per 30 dials and 1 connect per 10 dials.]

Version D — Voicemail Scripts

CRITICAL RULE: Do NOT leave a voicemail on your first 3 attempts. Leave a voicemail on

attempt 4 or 5. The goal of the voicemail is NOT to pitch the product — it is to earn a callback or prime them for your follow-up email. Keep it under 30 seconds. Create curiosity, not information overload.

Version D1 — Pest Control Voicemail

"Hey [First Name] — [Your Name] at FirstKnock. Quick question: do you know what percentage of the doors your reps knocked last week were rentals? Industry average is 35 to 50 percent — those people can never buy. I built a filter for that. I'm going to send you an email with a screenshot of your territory. Take a look and let me know if you want to see the rest of the map."

[Delivery Note: Calm, conversational pace. Not rushed. The question at the top ('do you know what percentage...') is designed to create a mental itch they can't scratch without calling back. The 'I'm going to send you an email' is a commitment — send it within 5 minutes of leaving the voicemail.]

Version D2 — Home Security Voicemail

"Hey [First Name] — [Your Name] at FirstKnock. I built a tool that shows your reps exactly which doors in their territory are new homeowners who moved in the last 90 days — the highest-intent security buyers in any zip code. I'm sending you an email with a live screenshot of your territory right now. If you want to see the full map, just reply and I'll set it up. Talk soon."

[Delivery Note: Slightly warmer tone than pest control version. 'Highest-intent security buyers' is a phrase that lands hard with security dealers who know their CAC is too high. 'Talk soon' at the end signals confidence — not desperation. Send the email immediately.]

Version E — They Answer But Immediately Say 'Who Is This?'

"[Your Name] — I built a territory intelligence platform for D2D pest control teams. I'm calling because I wanted to show you what your specific territory looks like on the map — specifically how many verified new homeowners are in your zip code right now. You got 30 seconds?"

[Tone Note: No apology. No 'sorry to bother you.' State your name, state what you built, state why you're calling, ask for 30 seconds. The 'you got 30 seconds?' is a pattern interrupt — it's direct, it's respectful of their time, and it signals you're not going to waste it. Founder energy: calm, certain, unhurried.]

SECTION 3: THE 30-SECOND FOUNDER PITCH

Each pitch below is written to be delivered in 30 seconds at a natural, unhurried pace (75-85 words). Lead with pain. Drop one stat that makes them pause. End with a question that makes them think. Do not rush. Do not add to it. The silence after the question is intentional — let it breathe.

Pitch 1 — Pest Control

FRAME: Rental door waste + rep churn from bad data + new homeowners = highest intent buyers

in first 90 days.

"Here's the problem I kept seeing: 35 to 50 percent of the doors your reps knock are rentals — those people can never buy, no matter how good the pitch is. That rejection burns reps out, and burned-out reps quit. Replacing one rep costs between \$75,000 and \$145,000 when you factor in recruiting, training, and lost pipeline. I built FirstKnock to fix that. It filters out every rental in a territory and shows your reps only the verified homeowners who bought in the last 30 to 90 days — the highest-intent buyers in any zip code. How many reps did you lose last summer?"

WHY THIS WORKS — Pest Control Pitch

- Opens with a specific, verifiable pain point ('35-50% of doors are rentals') — not a vague claim. Specificity signals expertise and immediately disrupts the status quo.
- The phrase 'those people can never buy, no matter how good the pitch is' removes the rep's ego from the equation. It's not their fault — it's the data. This is validating and disarming.
- 'Burned-out reps quit' connects the tactical problem (bad doors) to the strategic pain (churn) in one sentence. The owner feels this every summer.
- The \$75,000-\$145,000 stat reframes the cost of the problem. It's not about software cost — it's about the cost of NOT having this.
- 'I built FirstKnock to fix that' — three words that establish founder authority and product conviction simultaneously.
- The closing question ('How many reps did you lose last summer?') is designed to make them do math in their head. If the answer is more than zero, the ROI conversation has already started.

Pitch 2 — Home Security

FRAME: New homeowners = #1 security buyer + the window is short (first 90 days) + reps are missing these doors because they have no systematic way to target them.

"New homeowners are your highest-intent security buyers — they're actively looking to secure a property they just invested in. But the window is short: the first 90 days. After that, they've either bought from you or bought from a competitor. The problem is your reps have no systematic way to find those doors. They're knocking blind. Here's what that costs: 100 cold doors gets you about 1 close. 40 FirstKnock doors — verified new homeowners in your territory — gets you 8. Same rep, same pitch. What does your team's current close rate look like on new homeowner doors specifically?"

WHY THIS WORKS — Home Security Pitch

- Opens by naming the #1 buyer segment ('new homeowners are your highest-intent security buyers') — this is market intelligence, not a sales pitch. It positions you as a peer sharing valuable data.

- 'The window is short: the first 90 days' creates urgency without manufactured pressure. It's a real market dynamic, and the owner knows it's true the moment they hear it.
- 'They've either bought from you or bought from a competitor' is a loss-aversion trigger. The fear of losing a high-intent buyer to a competitor is more motivating than the prospect of gaining one.
- The 100-door vs. 40-door stat is the most powerful number in the pitch. It doesn't require explanation — the math is self-evident and the implication is immediate.
- 'Same rep, same pitch' is critical. It removes the objection that this requires changing how reps work. It's purely about the quality of the doors.
- The closing question ('What does your team's current close rate look like on new homeowner doors specifically?') is designed to expose a gap. Most owners don't track this — and the moment they realize they don't know, they want to know.

SECTION 4: THE TRIAL CLOSE

Part 1 — Reading the Buying Signals

These six phrases are not questions — they are buying signals disguised as questions. When you hear any of them, the prospect has mentally moved from 'who is this?' to 'could this work for me?' Your job is to recognize the signal and respond in a way that deepens engagement rather than triggering a price objection.

Table 1 — Buying Signal Recognition & Response Guide

What They Say	What It REALLY Means	How to Respond
"How does it work exactly?"	I'm intrigued but I need to visualize it before I commit to a demo. I'm not ready to say yes, but I'm not saying no.	"Best way to show you is on a live screen share — I'll pull up your actual territory and walk you through it in real time. Takes 15 minutes. You free Thursday or Friday?"
"What does it cost?"	I'm evaluating whether this is worth my time. I'm not objecting to the price — I'm trying to decide if I should keep listening.	"Before I give you a number, let me ask — what's a new customer worth to you annually? Because the math on this changes pretty fast depending on your contract value."

"How many companies are using this?"	I want social proof. I don't want to be the first person to take a risk on something unproven.	"I'm still early — which is actually why I'm calling personally instead of sending a sales rep. I'm working directly with a select group of operators right now to make sure the product is dialed in for teams like yours. That means you get direct access to me, not a support ticket."
"Does it work in [city]?"	I'm mentally placing my team on this map. I'm already imagining using it.	"Yes — I can actually pull up [city] right now and show you the verified new homeowner doors in your zip code. That's exactly what the 15-minute walkthrough is. You want to see it?"
"How long does it take to set up?"	I'm past the 'is this real' stage. I'm now evaluating implementation friction. This is a late-stage buying signal.	"Your reps can be live on the map the same day. There's no migration, no training — they open the app and the verified doors are already there. Setup is on my end, not yours."
"My reps are always complaining about bad leads"	You just named my exact problem. I've been living with this pain and I haven't found a solution yet.	"That's exactly why I built this. Bad leads aren't a rep problem — they're a data problem. Let me show you what your territory looks like with the rentals filtered out. You free for 15 minutes this week?"

Part 2 — The Trial Close Script

"Here's what I want to do — I don't want to sell you anything today. I want to show you what your territory looks like on the map. Takes 15 minutes. If you see what I think you're going to see, we can talk about getting your team on a trial. If it doesn't blow you away, I'll leave you alone. You free [day] or [day] this week?"

[Tone Note: Deliver this slowly and with complete calm. The phrase 'I don't want to sell you anything today' is a pattern interrupt — it removes the defensive posture most prospects carry into a sales call. The 'if it doesn't blow you away, I'll leave you alone' is a low-risk guarantee that makes the yes feel safe. The binary day choice ('Thursday or Friday?') is a closing technique — it moves the conversation from 'should I do this?' to 'when should I do this?']

WHY THIS FRAMING WORKS

- Low Cognitive Load: 'Demo' implies a 60-minute slide deck. '15-minute map walkthrough' implies a quick, visual, highly relevant exercise. Decision-makers are overwhelmed — reduce the perceived commitment.
- Immediate Relevance: 'Your territory' triggers territorial instincts. You're not showing them a generic product — you're showing them their specific zip code, their specific doors.
- The Sandler Approach: Equal business stature, upfront agreements. You're not begging for a meeting — you're offering a conditional exchange. 'If it doesn't blow you away, I'll leave you alone' is an upfront agreement that signals confidence.
- 60% of decision-makers prefer cold calls for high-value solutions, and 78-82% will accept meetings initiated by cold calls. The ask is not unusual — the framing just needs to be right.
- The binary day choice ('Thursday or Friday?') is a proven closing technique. It moves the conversation from 'should I?' to 'when?' — a much easier decision.

Part 3 — Immediate Calendar Close

ONCE THEY AGREE TO A TIME:

"Perfect. What's the best email to send the calendar invite to? I'll send it right now while we're on the phone."

WHILE WAITING FOR THEM TO CONFIRM RECEIPT:

"I'm sending it now — it'll come from [your email]. While that's coming through, let me ask: how many reps are you running in the field right now? I want to make sure I pull the right territory size for the walkthrough."

[Tone Note: The question while waiting serves two purposes: it keeps the conversation warm while the invite sends, and it gathers qualification data you'll use to personalize the demo. Never let silence sit awkwardly after booking — use it to deepen the relationship.]

ONCE THEY CONFIRM RECEIPT:

"Got it — you're confirmed for [day] at [time]. I'll have your territory pulled up before we start so we can jump straight into the map. Talk then."

Part 4 — Same-Call Trial Close (For Hot Prospects)

USE THIS WHEN: The prospect has said something like 'this sounds interesting,' 'we've been looking for something like this,' or 'how do I get started?' These are green lights. Do not slow down to schedule a demo — close the trial on the spot.

"Here's what I want to do — instead of scheduling a walkthrough for later, let me just get you set up right now. I'll pull up your territory on a screen share, show you the verified doors, and if it looks like what I think it's going to look like, I'll activate a trial for your team today. You have your laptop open?"

IF THEY SAY YES:

"Perfect — go to [URL] and I'll walk you through it live. I'm going to show you your zip code first so

you can see exactly what your reps would be working with."

AFTER THE LIVE MAP WALKTHROUGH — THE TRIAL OFFER:

"So here's what I want to offer you: [TRIAL TERMS]. No credit card required to start. I want you to put your reps on this for [trial period] and see what happens to their close rate. If it doesn't move the needle, you walk away and I'll refund anything you've paid. But I think you're going to see the difference in the first week. You want to get your team on this today?"

[Tone Note: The trial offer framing removes financial risk. 'I want you to put your reps on this' is an operator-to-operator ask — you're not asking them to buy software, you're asking them to run an experiment. Operators love experiments. The 'I think you're going to see the difference in the first week' is a conviction statement — say it like you mean it, because you do.]

IF THEY SAY 'CAN YOU SEND ME THE LINK?' (Without Committing to a Screen Share):

"I can — but honestly, the map is a visual product and it's hard to understand what you're looking at without context. Give me 10 minutes right now and I'll walk you through your specific territory. If you want the link after that, I'll send it. But I think once you see your zip code, you won't need it. You have your laptop?"

[Tone Note: Do not send the link without a walkthrough. A link without context is a dead end — they'll click it, not understand what they're looking at, and never follow up. The walkthrough is the sale. Protect it.]

Part 5 — The Soft Close (Warm But Not Ready)

USE THIS WHEN: The prospect is interested but not ready to commit to a time. They're warm — don't lose them.

"I get it — timing isn't always right. Here's what I'll do: I'll put together a territory preview for your specific zip code — shows you the verified new homeowner doors in your area right now. I'll send it to your email so you can see what your reps would be working with. What's the best email for you?"

ONCE THEY GIVE THE EMAIL:

"Perfect. I'll send that over today. And when I do, I'll include a link to book a 15-minute walkthrough whenever the timing works for you. Fair enough?"

[Tone Note: The territory preview is a tangible deliverable that keeps the door open. It's not a generic brochure — it's a screenshot of their specific zip code. That specificity is what gets the email opened. Always confirm the follow-up action before hanging up.]

SECTION 5: FULL OBJECTION HANDLING GUIDE

Every objection below is written with the full psychology, the exact response, and the follow-up if they push back again. Do not abbreviate these in the field. The depth of your objection handle is what separates a founder who closes from a founder who gets brushed off.

[Competitor]"

WHAT'S REALLY HAPPENING:

Fear of switching costs and data migration. They've already made a decision and don't want to revisit it. They're also testing whether you'll back down or differentiate. This is the most important objection to handle well — it comes up most often and it's the one where most founders fold too quickly.

YOUR RESPONSE (General):

"That's good — what are you using? ... [Let them answer.] Got it. I'm not here to replace it. I want to ask you one question: what's your team's current close rate on new homeowner doors specifically — not all doors, just the ones where the homeowner bought in the last 90 days? ... [Let them answer.] That's the number I want to move. Most of the tools out there are great for mapping and routing, but they don't filter out rentals and they don't identify recently-sold homeowners at the door level. That's the gap I built FirstKnock to fill."

IF THEY USE SALESRABBIT:

"SalesRabbit is a solid drawing tool — I'm not going to knock it. But it's an empty map. You're still knocking blind because there's no rental filter and no recently-sold data built in. And if any of your reps are on Android, they're dealing with the app lagging and crashing at the door. Most of our clients kept SalesRabbit for a month while they tested us. They switched because their Android users were tired of losing their pins mid-route."

IF THEY USE ZILLOW / MLS LISTS / GENERIC LIST PROVIDERS:

"Having the list is step one. But how are you turning that list into a routable map on your reps' phones? And how are you tracking GPS proof-of-visit to confirm they actually knocked the list? Buying data and executing on data are two different problems. FirstKnock solves both."

IF THEY PUSH BACK AGAIN ('We're happy with what we have'):

"I respect that. Let me ask one more thing: if I could show you a live map of your territory with the rentals filtered out and the verified new homeowners highlighted — takes 15 minutes — and it didn't show you anything useful, would you tell me? ... [They say yes.] That's all I'm asking for. 15 minutes. If it's not useful, I'll leave you alone."

[Tone Note: Never attack the competitor directly. Acknowledge it, find the gap, and pivot to a specific question that exposes the gap. The close-rate question on new homeowner doors is the wedge — most owners don't track this, and the moment they realize they don't know, you've created a reason to look.]

Objection 2: "Not Interested"

WHAT'S REALLY HAPPENING:

This is a reflex, not a decision. They haven't heard enough to be genuinely uninterested — they're

pattern-matching to every other cold call they've received and trying to end it quickly. The goal is to interrupt the pattern without being pushy.

YOUR RESPONSE:

"Fair enough — I'm not going to push. Can I ask one quick question before I let you go? What are you using right now to make sure your reps aren't knocking rentals? ... [Let them answer.]"

IF THEY ENGAGE WITH THE QUESTION:

"That's interesting — [respond to their answer]. The reason I ask is that 35 to 50 percent of doors in most territories are rentals. If your reps are hitting those, that's the primary driver of burnout and churn. That's the problem I built FirstKnock to solve. If that's not a problem for you right now, I get it. But if it ever becomes one, I'd rather you already know what I built."

IF THEY'RE STILL COLD:

"Understood. I'll send you a quick email with a territory preview for your zip code — no pitch, just the data. If it's useful, great. If not, I won't bother you again. What's the best email?"

IF THEY PUSH BACK AGAIN ('I really don't have time for this'):

"Got it — I'll let you go. I'll send the territory preview to [email if you have it] and you can look at it when you have a minute. No follow-up call unless you want one. Take care."

[Tone Note: Graceful exit is a skill. If they're genuinely cold, don't burn the bridge — leave the door open with the territory preview. A 'not interested' today can become a 'call me back in Q3' if you exit with class. Never argue with a 'not interested.']

Objection 3: "Send Me an Email"

WHAT'S REALLY HAPPENING:

Classic brush-off to end the call quickly. They haven't been hooked yet and they're using email as an exit. The goal is to agree immediately (never argue with 'send me an email'), get the email address, and then pivot to the demo ask.

YOUR RESPONSE:

"Absolutely — what's the best email? ... [Get the email.] Perfect. I'll send that over today. And honestly, it's a visual product — email doesn't do it justice. I'd rather just pull up your territory on a screen share for 15 minutes. You free Thursday or Friday?"

IF THEY PUSH BACK AGAIN ('Just send the email, I'll take a look'):

"I will — and I'll include a link to book a 15-minute walkthrough whenever the timing works. But let me ask: do you have your laptop open right now? I can pull up your zip code in about 30 seconds and show you something specific to your territory. If it's not useful, I'll let you go."

[Tone Note: The pattern interrupt ('do you have your laptop open right now?') is designed to shift from a future commitment to an immediate action. If they're at their desk, there's a real chance they'll say yes. If they're in the field, they'll tell you — and now you have a reason to call back when they're at a desk.]

Routes"

WHAT'S REALLY HAPPENING:

Old-school grit mentality. They view software as a crutch or an unnecessary complexity. They're proud of their team's work ethic and don't want to imply their reps need help. The pivot is to reframe: this isn't about changing how reps work — it's about giving them better doors.

YOUR RESPONSE:

"I respect that — and I'm not here to change how your reps work. They can still run their routes however they want. The only difference is they'll be working verified homeowner doors instead of knocking rentals. Your reps can still knock every door on the block — FirstKnock just makes sure 35 to 50 percent of those doors aren't people who legally cannot buy from them."

IF THEY PUSH BACK AGAIN ('My reps are fine, it's a numbers game'):

"It is a numbers game — and the numbers are brutal right now. A 1 to 5 percent conversion rate on cold doors means your reps are getting rejected 95 to 99 times out of every 100 knocks. That's not a work ethic problem — that's a data problem. If they skip the 35 to 50 percent of doors that are rentals, they get 8 times the output with the exact same work ethic. The grit doesn't change. The doors do."

[Tone Note: Validate the grit mentality — don't fight it. Then use the math to show that grit applied to better doors produces exponentially better results. The phrase 'the grit doesn't change, the doors do' is a line worth memorizing.]

Objection 5: "How Much Does It Cost?"

WHAT'S REALLY HAPPENING:

They're evaluating ROI before they understand the value. If you lead with price, you lose — because any number sounds expensive before they understand what it prevents. The goal is to anchor the value first, then introduce the price in the context of the ROI.

YOUR RESPONSE:

"Before I give you a number, let me ask — what's a new customer worth to you annually? ... [Let them answer.] And how many reps are you running? ... [Let them answer.] Okay — so if FirstKnock increases each rep's close rate by even 2 to 3 deals a month, what does that math look like for you? ... [Let them do the math.] That's the context I want you to have before I give you a price. Because the number I'm going to give you is going to look very different against that math than it does in isolation."

IF THEY PUSH BACK AGAIN ('Just give me a ballpark'):

"Fair enough. It costs less than replacing one rep. Replacing a single D2D rep costs between \$3,000 and \$8,000 in direct costs alone — and up to \$145,000 when you factor in lost pipeline and training. FirstKnock prevents that by giving your reps better doors so they don't burn out. The

specific pricing depends on team size — let me show you the territory first and then we can talk numbers that actually make sense for your operation."

[Tone Note: Never dodge the price question entirely — that signals you're hiding something. But always anchor the value before the number. 'It costs less than replacing one rep' is a powerful reframe that makes the price feel like insurance, not an expense.]

Objection 6: "I Need to Think About It / Talk to My Partner"

WHAT'S REALLY HAPPENING:

They're interested but not ready to commit alone. This is not a rejection — it's a stall. The goal is to respect the process while locking in a specific next step before hanging up. A vague 'I'll think about it' without a follow-up date is a dead lead.

YOUR RESPONSE:

"Totally makes sense — I'd want to do the same. When are you talking to them? ... [Let them answer.] Perfect. What if we did this: I'll send you the territory preview for your zip code today so you have something concrete to show them. And then let's get a 15-minute call on the calendar for [day after they talk to partner] — that way you've both seen the data and we can answer any questions together. Does that work?"

IF THEY PUSH BACK AGAIN ('We'll reach out when we're ready'):

"I hear you. I'll send the territory preview today and I'll follow up in [specific timeframe — e.g., 'two weeks']. If the timing works before then, just reply to the email and I'll get you on the calendar. Fair?"

[Tone Note: Always lock in a specific next step before hanging up. 'I'll reach out when we're ready' is a polite way of saying 'don't call me.' Counter it by putting the ball in their court with a concrete deliverable (territory preview) and a specific follow-up date. Never leave a call without a next action.]

Objection 7: "We Tried Something Like This Before and It Didn't Work"

WHAT'S REALLY HAPPENING:

They've been burned before. They're not skeptical of the category — they're skeptical of the execution. The goal is to validate the frustration, find out what they tried, and differentiate on the specific layer that failed them.

YOUR RESPONSE:

"I hear that — what were you using? ... [Let them answer.] Yeah, most of those tools pull from MLS or Zillow data, which is either stale or doesn't filter out rentals. The data looks good on paper but it falls apart at the door. The difference with FirstKnock is a 3-step verification layer that filters out rentals and confirms the homeowner bought within the last 30 to 90 days. That's not a list — that's

a qualified door. What specifically didn't work about what you tried?"

IF THEY PUSH BACK AGAIN ('I just don't think the data is ever accurate enough'):

"That's a fair concern — and it's exactly why I built the verification layer the way I did. Let me show you your specific territory and you can tell me if the data looks accurate. If it doesn't, I'll tell you myself and we won't waste each other's time. But I think you're going to be surprised. 15 minutes — you free Thursday?"

[Tone Note: Validate the frustration first — never dismiss a bad past experience. Then differentiate on the specific technical layer that failed them (data accuracy, rental filtering). The offer to 'tell you myself if it doesn't look accurate' is a confidence signal that builds trust.]

Objection 8: "I'm Too Busy Right Now"

WHAT'S REALLY HAPPENING:

They're genuinely busy, or they haven't heard anything compelling enough to justify stopping what they're doing. The goal is to respect their time immediately, then use a single pattern-interrupt question to create enough curiosity to earn 60 more seconds.

YOUR RESPONSE:

"Totally — I'll be quick. One question: do you know what percentage of the doors your reps knocked last week were rentals? ... [Let them answer or admit they don't know.]"

IF THEY DON'T KNOW:

"Industry average is 35 to 50 percent. That means your reps are spending half their day pitching people who legally cannot buy. That's the primary driver of burnout and churn. I built a filter for that. When's a better time to show you — tomorrow morning or end of day Thursday?"

IF THEY PUSH BACK AGAIN ('Seriously, not a good time'):

"Understood — I'll send you a quick territory preview for your zip code and follow up [specific day]. What's the best email?"

[Tone Note: The rental percentage question is the best pattern interrupt in the playbook. It's specific, it's operational, and it creates a mental itch. If they don't know the answer, you've just created a reason for them to want to know — and you're the only person who can show them.]

Objection 9: "My Reps Are Doing Fine / We're Hitting Our Numbers"

WHAT'S REALLY HAPPENING:

They're proud of their team and don't want to imply there's a problem. They may also be genuinely performing well. The goal is to validate the success and reframe FirstKnock as an accelerant for a good team, not a fix for a broken one.

YOUR RESPONSE:

"That's great — and honestly, the teams that get the most out of FirstKnock are usually the ones already performing well. It's not a fix for a broken team — it's an accelerant for a good one. If your

reps are already closing at a strong rate on cold doors, imagine what they do when every door is a verified new homeowner who bought in the last 90 days. What does your best rep close per week right now?"

IF THEY PUSH BACK AGAIN ('We really don't need anything right now'):

"I hear you. Let me ask one thing: what's your rep retention looking like? Because the teams that are hitting their numbers today are usually the ones who lose their best reps to burnout in the summer when the territory gets stale. I'd rather show you this before that happens than after. 15 minutes — worth it?"

[Tone Note: Never argue with success. Validate it, then plant the seed of what's possible. The question about rep retention is a forward-looking pain point — even teams hitting their numbers today are vulnerable to summer churn. This creates urgency without manufactured pressure.]

Objection 10: "I've Never Heard of You"

WHAT'S REALLY HAPPENING:

They're looking for social proof and brand recognition before investing time. This is actually an opportunity — lean into being early, being the founder, and being personally invested in making it work for them.

YOUR RESPONSE:

"Yeah— I built this about [X months] ago. I'm still early, which is actually why I'm calling personally. I'm not sending a sales rep — I'm calling because I want to talk to operators who actually run D2D teams and make sure what I built solves the real problem. The companies I'm working with right now are getting direct access to me, not a support ticket. That's not something you get from SalesRabbit or Spotio."

IF THEY PUSH BACK AGAIN ('How do I know this is legit?'):

"Fair question. Give me 15 minutes and I'll pull up your territory live on a screen share. You'll see the data, you'll see the map, you'll see the rental filter working in real time. If it doesn't look like what I described, you'll know in the first 5 minutes and you can hang up. But I think you're going to want to see the rest of it. You free Thursday?"

[Tone Note: Being early is a feature, not a bug. The founder calling personally, offering direct access, and being willing to show the product live in 15 minutes is a level of accountability that no established vendor can match. Own the early-stage positioning — it's your competitive advantage right now.]

SECTION 6: CALL OPTIMIZATION & DAILY EXECUTION

Best Times to Call — Pest Control Owners

Table 2 — Pest Control Owner Call Windows

Window	Time	Why It Works	Priority
Morning Window	8:00 AM – 10:00 AM	Owners are dispatching crews for the day. They're at their desk, phone in hand, making operational decisions. This is the highest-attention window of the day.	
Afternoon Window	4:00 PM – 5:00 PM	Crews are returning from the field. Owners transition from field management to administrative work. Second-highest attention window.	
Micro-Timing Hack	XX:25 and XX:55	Call during the 5-minute windows just before the half-hour and hour marks. Owners are between tasks or wrapping up meetings — more receptive to a quick call.	
Avoid: Lunch	12:00 PM – 1:00 PM	74.1% of calls go unanswered during busy periods. Owners are either eating or handling mid-day field	BLACKOUT
Avoid: Early Morning	Before 8:00 AM	Owners are in pre-dispatch mode. Interrupting this window creates friction and a negative first impression.	BLACKOUT
Avoid: Late Friday	After 3:00 PM Friday	Worst performance day across all metrics. Owners are mentally checked out and unlikely to commit to a demo.	BLACKOUT

Table 3 — Home Security Dealer Call Windows

Window	Time	Why It Works	Priority
Morning Window	8:00 AM – 10:00 AM	Dealers are briefing their D2D teams before they hit the field. Decision-makers are at their desks and in operational mode.	
Afternoon Window	4:00 PM – 5:00 PM	Reps are returning from the field. Dealers are reviewing daily numbers and thinking about territory performance — exactly when your pitch is most	
Micro-Timing Hack	XX:25 and XX:55	Same principle as pest control — catch them in transition between tasks.	
Avoid: Lunch	12:00 PM – 1:00 PM	Same blackout as pest control. Low connect rates, low attention.	BLACKOUT
Avoid: Monday	All day Monday	Least effective day across all metrics. Owners are in reactive mode from weekend issues.	AVOID
Avoid: Friday PM	After 3:00 PM Friday	Worst conversion day. No demos get booked on Friday afternoons.	BLACKOUT

Best Days of the Week — Ranked

Table 4 — Day-of-Week Performance Rankings

Rank	Day	Performance	Data Point
1	Wednesday	Best overall	Highest conversion, pickup, and booking rates. Tuesdays and Wednesdays combined account for 44% of all booked demos.
2	Tuesday	Excellent	Second-best day. Strong connect rates and demo conversion.
3	Thursday	Good	Solid performance, especially for afternoon callbacks.
4	Friday AM	Acceptable	Morning only. Performance drops sharply after 3 PM.
5	Monday	Poor	Least effective day. Owners are in reactive mode.
6	Friday PM	Worst	Worst performance across all metrics. Avoid.

LOCAL TIME ZONE ALIGNMENT: Always call in the prospect's local time zone. Aligning calls with the prospect's local time zone increases connect rates by 27%. If you're on the East Coast calling a West Coast pest control owner at 8 AM your time, you're calling them at 5 AM. That is not a recoverable first impression.

Voicemail Strategy

The core principle: live conversations are 6x more effective than voicemails. Voicemails are not a sales tool — they are a priming tool. Their job is to make the prospect slightly more likely to answer your next call or respond to your follow-up email.

Table 5 — Voicemail Attempt Sequence

Attempt #	Action	Rationale
1	Dial, no voicemail	Reps who make 6+ call attempts are 70% more likely to connect. Don't burn your voicemail slot early.
2	Dial, no voicemail	Still in the connect window. Keep trying for a live conversation.
3	Dial, no voicemail	Third attempt. Still prioritize live connection over voicemail.
4	Leave voicemail (Version D1 or D2)	Now leave the voicemail. Immediately send the follow-up email with territory preview screenshot.
5	Dial — reference the voicemail if they answer	If they answer: 'Hey [Name] — I left you a voicemail yesterday about the rental filter for your territory. Did you get a chance to see the email I sent?'
6+	Continue dialing on best-day/best-time schedule	80% of sales require 5+ follow-up calls. Persistence on the right schedule is the strategy.

The Voicemail + Email 1-2 Punch

The voicemail and the follow-up email are a single unit — not two separate actions. The voicemail creates the curiosity. The email delivers the proof. Here is the exact sequence:

1. Leave the voicemail (Version D1 or D2 from Section 2) — reference that you're sending an email.
2. Within 5 minutes of hanging up, send the follow-up email with a screenshot of their specific territory (their zip code, their verified new homeowner doors).
3. Subject line: 'Your territory — [City/Zip Code]' — no pitch, just the data.
4. Email body: 3 sentences max. 'I just left you a voicemail. Here's a screenshot of your territory with the rentals filtered out and the verified new homeowners highlighted. If you want to see the full map, reply here or book a 15-minute walkthrough: [calendar link].'
5. On your next dial attempt, reference both: 'Hey [Name] — I left you a voicemail and sent an email with a screenshot of your territory. Did you get a chance to see it?'

Call Volume Benchmarks — Solo Founder

These are realistic benchmarks for a solo founder doing manual dialing. Not SDR benchmarks. Not auto-dialer benchmarks. What you can actually do while also running a company.

Table 6 — Solo Founder Call Volume Benchmarks

Metric	Realistic Target	Top-End Target	Notes
Dials per hour (manual)	15–20	25	Manual dialing with CRM logging. Don't sacrifice quality for volume.
Dials per session (2-hour block)	30–40	50	Two focused 2-hour blocks per day is sustainable.
Connect rate (cold, small business)	6–8%	10–12%	Industry benchmark is 2-12.1%. Small business owners answer more than
Connect-to-conversation rate	40–50%	56%	enterprise. Not every connect becomes a real conversation. Some hang up immediately.
Conversation-to-demo rate	10–15%	20%	Average performers: 4.6-4.82%. Top performers: up to 16.7%. Target 15%.
Dial-to-demo rate (overall)	1–3%	5%	This is the number that matters most for pipeline planning.

The Math — Explicit

Here is the exact math you need to plan your pipeline. Run this every week to know if you're on track:

Table 7 — Pipeline Math by Scenario

Scenario	Dials/Day	Connect Rate	Connects/Day	Connect-to-Demo Rate	Demos/Day	Demos/Week
Conservative	50	6%	3	10%	0.3	1.5
Realistic	50	8%	4	15%	0.6	3
Strong	75	10%	7.5	15%	1.1	5.5
Top-End	75	12%	9	20%	1.8	9

THE BASELINE TARGET: 50 dials/day at 8% connect = 4 conversations. At 15% connect-to-demo

= ~1 demo every 2 days. That is 2-3 demos per week from a single founder doing 2 focused hours of dialing per day. At a 30% demo-to-trial close rate, that is 1 new trial every 10 days. This is a real, achievable pipeline.

What 'Good' Looks Like — Day 1, Week 1, Month 1

Table 8 — Performance Milestones by Timeframe

Timeframe	Dials	Connects	Demos	Trials	Primary Goal
Day 1	30–40	2–3	0–1	0	Warm up the pitch. Identify what's landing and what isn't. Don't judge results.
Week 1	200–250	15–20	3–5	0–1	Refine the pitch based on real objections. Book your first
Month 1	800–1,000	60–80	12–20	2–5	Close your first 2-3 trials. Build a follow-up sequence for warm leads.

Disposition Tracking System

Track every call. Every call. The data you collect in the first 30 days is more valuable than any market research — it tells you exactly what's working, what's not, and where the real objections live.

Table 9 — Call Disposition Tracking Fields

Field	Options / Format	Notes
Company Name	Text	Include city/state for territory tracking
Owner Name	Text	Update if you get it from a gatekeeper
Phone	Text	Note if direct line or main number
Date/Time Called	MM/DD/YYYY HH:MM	Critical for timing optimization
DM Reached?	Yes / No / Gatekeeper / Voicemail	Track separately from outcome

Outcome	Interested / Not Interested / Callback Scheduled / Demo Booked / Trial Closed / Do Not Call	Primary disposition field
Objection Given	Text	Exact words they used — not your interpretation
What Resonated	Text	What part of the pitch got a reaction? Note it.
Vertical	Pest Control / Home Security / Other	Track separately — pitch performance varies by vertical
Follow-Up Date	MM/DD/YYYY	Never leave a call without a follow-up date
Notes	Free text	Anything operational: team size, current tool, rep count, seasonality comments

Between-Call Habits

The 60 seconds between calls is not dead time — it is the most important minute of your dialing session. Use it deliberately.

1. Log the disposition immediately — before you dial the next number. Memory degrades fast. If you wait until the end of the session, you'll lose the nuance of what was said.
2. Note one thing that worked and one thing that didn't on the last call. Not a full debrief — just one line each. Over 50 calls, this becomes a pattern.
3. Take three slow breaths. Not metaphorically — literally. The physiological reset between calls prevents the emotional bleed from a tough call into the next one.
4. Reset your frame: 'The next person I call has the problem I solved. I'm calling to find out if the timing is right.' Say it in your head before you dial.
5. Check the time zone of the next number before dialing. One second of verification prevents a 5 AM call to a West Coast owner.

When to Stop for the Day

Quality degradation is real and it shows up in your voice before you notice it in your results. Watch for these signals:

- You start rushing through the pitch — skipping the pause after the opening question.
- You feel defensive when someone says 'not interested' instead of curious.
- You start hoping people don't answer.
- You've been dialing for more than 90 minutes without a break.
- Your last 3 connects all ended in under 60 seconds with no engagement.

- **THE RULE:** If you notice any two of these signals at the same time, stop. A bad dialing session does more damage than no dialing session — it burns bridges and trains bad habits.

The First 10 Calls Rule

THE FIRST 10 CALLS RULE: Treat the first 10 calls of any dialing session as warm-up, not performance. Your pitch will be slightly off, your timing will be slightly slow, and your energy will be building. Do not judge your results on the first 10 calls. Do not change your pitch based on the first 10 calls. Warm up, find your rhythm, then perform.

SECTION 7: THE QUICK REFERENCE CARD

Print this page. Keep it at your desk. Read the top line before every dialing session.

MINDSET RESET — READ BEFORE EVERY SESSION

"I built this. I believe in this. I'm calling to find people who have the problem I solved. Rejection is data. The goal is qualify fast, pitch sharp, close hard, move on."

QUALIFIER FLOW

Quick Reference — Qualifier Flow

Scenario	Exact Opener
Got the name	"Hey [First Name] — this is [Your Name] at FirstKnock. Did I catch you at a bad time?"
No name	"Hey — I'm trying to reach the owner of [Company Name]. Is that something you can help me with?"
Gatekeeper	"I noticed [Company] is hiring sales reps — I built something for growing D2D teams. Is [Owner] available for 30 seconds?"
They say 'who is this?'	"[Your Name] — I built a territory intelligence platform for D2D teams. You got 30 seconds?"
Voicemail (Pest Control)	"Do you know what % of your reps' doors last week were rentals? Industry average is 35-50%. I built a filter for that. Sending you an email now."
Voicemail (Security)	"I built a tool that shows your reps exactly which doors are new homeowners from the last 90 days — your highest-intent buyers. Sending your territory preview now."

- 35-50% of doors are rentals — those people can NEVER buy
- Rejection from bad doors = burnout = churn
- Replacing one rep costs \$75K-\$145K
- New homeowners in last 30-90 days = highest-intent buyers in any zip code
- CLOSE: "How many reps did you lose last summer?"

HOME SECURITY PITCH — KEY PHRASES

- New homeowners = #1 security buyer — actively securing a new investment
- The window is 90 days — after that, they've bought from you or a competitor
- Reps are knocking blind — no systematic way to find these doors
- 100 cold doors = 1 close. 40 FirstKnock doors = 8 closes. Same rep, same pitch.
- CLOSE: "What does your team's current close rate look like on new homeowner doors specifically?"

BUYING SIGNALS — THEY'RE INTERESTED WHEN THEY SAY:

1. "How does it work exactly?" rightarrow Show them live. Book the walkthrough.
2. "What does it cost?" rightarrow Anchor ROI first. Ask contract value.
3. "How many companies are using this?" rightarrow Lean into being early. Direct access to founder.
4. "Does it work in [city]?" rightarrow "Yes — I can pull up [city] right now."
5. "How long does it take to set up?" rightarrow "Same day. No training needed."
6. "My reps always complain about bad leads" rightarrow "That's exactly why I built this."

TRIAL CLOSE — 2-SENTENCE VERSION

"I don't want to sell you anything today — I want to show you what your territory looks like on the map. Takes 15 minutes, and if it doesn't blow you away, I'll leave you alone. You free Thursday or Friday?"

TOP 5 OBJECTIONS — ONE-LINE RESPONSES

Quick Reference — Top 5 Objection Responses

Objection	One-Line Response
Already have something / use [competitor]	"What's your close rate on new homeowner doors specifically? That's the number I move."
Not interested	"Fair enough — quick question before I let you go: what are you using to filter out rentals?"

Send me an email	"Absolutely — what's the best email? And honestly, it's visual — 15 minutes on a screen share does more than any email. Free Thursday?"
How much does it cost?	"Before I give you a number — what's a new customer worth to you annually? The math changes fast."
Never heard of you	"I built this [X months] ago. I'm calling personally — not sending a rep — because I want to talk to operators who actually run D2D teams."

CALL WINDOWS — BEST TIMES

Quick Reference — Call Windows

Window	Time	Note
Morning	8:00–10:00 AM (local)	Dispatching crews. Highest attention.
Afternoon	4:00–5:00 PM (local)	End of field day. Admin mode.
Micro-hack	XX:25 and XX:55	Between tasks. Pattern interrupt.
Best days	Tuesday + Wednesday	44% of all demos booked on these two days.
BLACKOUT	12–1 PM, before 8 AM, Friday PM	74.1% unanswered. Don't waste dials.

CALL OUTCOMES TO LOG

Interested | Not Interested | Callback Scheduled | Demo Booked | Trial Closed | Do Not Call

Log every call. Note the objection given, what resonated, and the follow-up date. The data from your first 30 days is your most valuable asset.

THE DAILY MATH

502 focused hours Dials/Day Target	4Per day Connects at 8%	~1At 15% connect-to-demo Demo per 2 Days	2–3Sustainable solo founder pace Demos/Week
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"The pest control industry is a \$24.9B market growing to \$42.5B by 2032. There are 32,720+ active pest control companies in the US. You are not running out of prospects. Dial."